

when another concept was born. Why not make controllers and microprocessors that are specific to a task that we need them to perform? Why not make this so compact that it can be fitted inside the small devices that we want them to drive? The Silicon Valley was just getting born. Giants like IBM were showing no signs of stopping and were debating that the future indeed lies with the processors. This was the time when the concept of System on a Chip was first devised. It is very hard to trace the true origins of this concept – for it is vast and vague in its implementation. It started with something minuscule and later became the driving force behind major billion dollar industries. Little did the people of the 70s know that this elegant wizardry in building the tiny circuits and connecting them to specific peripherals could become a limitless and endless gateway to making gadgets more compact and functional. In this issue, we lay focus on the concept of System On a Chip which truly had humble beginnings but has vast potential in the future. We are nowhere close to tapping the full potential of this concept, for the concept has broken the boundaries of digital logic and entered the field of bio-engineering. We shall try to understand what an SoC is and where the need for it rises from. First, we shall briefly discuss it's architecture and design and explore it in further detail later. Then we shall take a look at what is, and what could be.



A primitive digital watch. The digital watch was the first device to witness the revolution